

Despite appearances, these deformities never offer any mechanical advantages on their own, though they could perhaps be used to justify purchasing certain Merits (or Flaws). These deformities also carry over to the mortal seeming in a non-paranormal but still memorably unsettling form — instead of looking outright reptilian, a Balor with patches of lizard scales might appear to “merely” have a strange skin condition in his mortal guise. Investigators trying to track one of the Blooded receive a –2 on the difficulty of rolls related to witnesses remembering, describing, and identifying the noble unless the Balor took special pains to conceal his abnormality.

Due to their savage Fomorian blood, members of House Balor also have a maximum Willpower rating of 6. Kithain who take titles later on and have a higher Willpower rating find it reduced during their initiation into the house’s mysteries.

Exile

While the specifics remain frustratingly vague, House Balor has no illusions about what likely led to their exile — they backed the losing side, and paid for it. Rather than scheme about ways to re-enter Arcadia, however, the Blooded have a different plan. They intend to conquer the Autumn World and thereby cut off its supply of Glamour to Arcadia. House Balor will not grovel and beg to be taken back; the Blooded will force Arcadia to its knees.

Factions and Societies

The Eyes of Balor, spies and assassins who use the house’s reputed lack of subtlety to their advantage. The Old Firm, members who coordinate jobs across a dozen different organized crime families and underworld syndicates. The Masters of the Dance, envoys and scholars who deal with various Prodigal allies. The Guardians of the Gates, trod-walkers and monster slayers who sometimes conspire with some of the more intelligent creatures they battle. The Riders of the Fell, brave (or foolhardy) risk-takers who seek to prove their worth through spectacular feats and harrowing battles. Scarlet Eye Solutions, a global private military contractor and security consulting firm with a fearsome reputation for getting results at all costs.

Notable Members

High Lord Li-Tilli, raised among werewolves and a consummate strategist, though now whispered to be sliding into Bedlam, The Mercy of Balor, a scarred and fearsome troll who acts as a sanctioned executioner for the Blooded, Countess Anne Blackwell, charming hostess, criminal mastermind, and ruthless Ravager from the Old Firm, Lord Ragnall, leader of the Masters of the Dance and expert on matters Prodigal, Sir Garreth Petrov-Smythe, sluagh terrorizer and top agent of the Eyes of Balor, and Doctor Jackknife, crazed goblin weapon designer and “combat prosthetics” developer for Scarlet Eye Solutions.

house Beaumayn

(BEAU-main)

This day I swear loyalty to the Book and the Blade, to the future that is my destiny, the present that is my duty and the past that is my treasure. I swear loyalty to the members and goals of House Beaumayn, and may the dreams of the damned haunt my mind should I ever break this trust. As the dark star burns above, so does my heart burn in service to thee.

Court: Seelie

Nicknames: Dark Stars, Hopeless (vulgar)

A house of prophets, occultists, and monster hunters, House Beaumayn is infamous among the nobility for its reluctance to participate in traditional politics, preferring to occupy a niche as Thallain hunters and keep a watchful eye out for Shadow Court extremists. Combined with their perceived aloofness and often cryptic manner, this self-appointed role does little to endear them to either Court, and so the Beaumayn are one of the most solitary noble houses, second only to House Scathach in that regard.

For what it’s worth, the Dark Stars are generally content with this role. Their gifts of prophecy place them in situations where they are needed, and while hunting Thallain and other creatures of darkness may not be the safest vocation, it is hard to argue that it doesn’t do real good. While it pains them to be so misunderstood by the rest of their kind, it’s not exactly unfamiliar territory. When a Beaumayn does make friends, though, she stands fast by them regardless of what it costs her; she simply doesn’t have so many that she can afford to lose a single one.

